Plain reading of the Bible – doesn't MyBible have too many distracting bells and whistles while lacking essential possibilities?

 **mybible.zone**/android/how-to/plain-reading

⬆ All "How to" articles

So you've started MyBible for the first time. If you patiently gave the "Welcome" screen (that appears first) a few seconds to download default modules in the language of your device (and at the same time to give you some initial infirmation), – upon its dismissing you will see a text of a Bible module in the language of your device; for English that will be KJV+ (King James, with embedded Strong's numbers).

There is the Bible text area and the header buttons. Practually all aspects of MyBible **appearance and behavior are adjustable** to your needs and liking; to get you started, **the following describes the default behavior** in the default appearance.

Fow now, please ignore all the header buttons except the one in the middle – the **Bible position button** that shows the Bible reference for the topmost shown verse – the **current verse**.

MyBible shows to you the text of a current Bible book as a scroll. **There are no text pages** in MyBible; chapters follow one another. Such an approach to presenting the Bible text is quire intentional – it allows you to put any place of a book into the center of your screen and study it in its immediate context.

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- 6. Selection of a Bible module
- 7. Lacking something you are used to?
- 8. Too much of everyting?

Basic navigation

- A tap on the right half of the screen, as well as a press of the device's volume down button, scrolls a **screen down**.
- Similarly, the left half of the screen and the volume up button scroll a **screen up**.
- A horizontal swipe right-to-left navigates to the **next chapter**.
- Similarly, a horizontal swipe left-to-right navigates to the **previous chapter**.
- A horizontal swipe right-to-left with two fingers navigates to the **next book**. Note that this is the second way to navigate to the next book: you can get there with a single swipe with two fingers or with several swipes with one finger – because the first chapter of the next book follows the last chapter of a previous book.
- Similarly, a horizontal swipe left-to-right with two fingers navigates to the **previous book**.

The long-tap on the Bible text is for selecting of verses and then performing different actions on the selection.

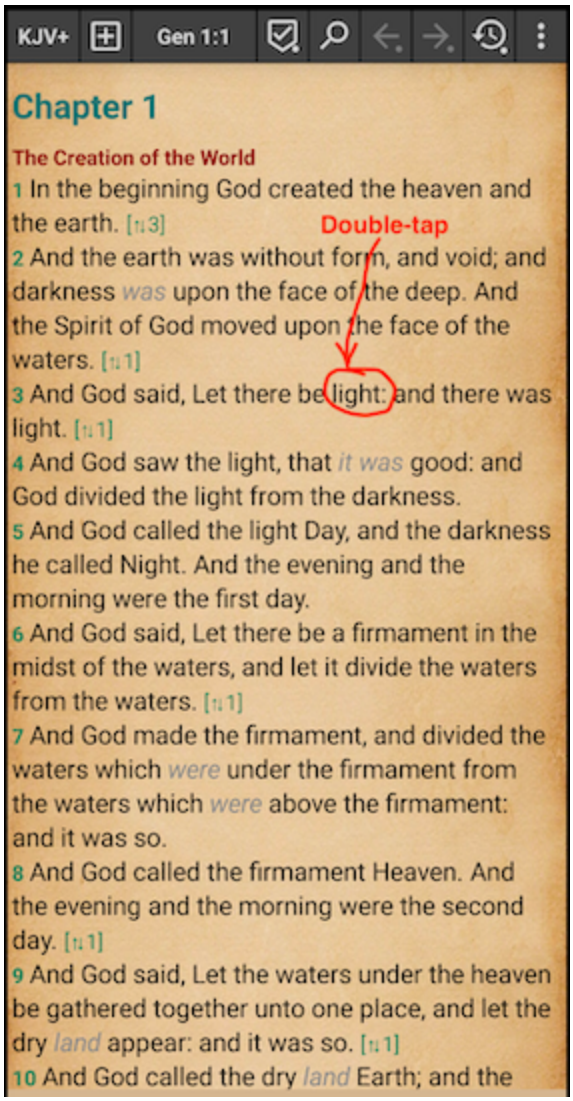
Links in the Bible text

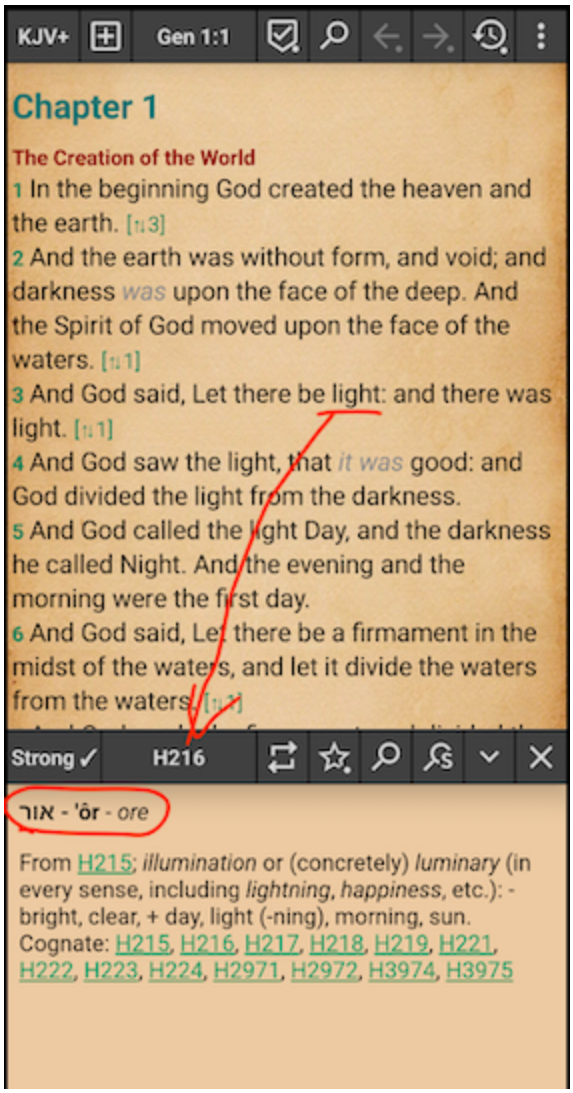
You can activate links in the Bible text by a **double-tap** on them.

There are several types of **explicit links** – colored in the hyperlink color. The ones shown by default deal with **cross-references** that connect related Bible places:

- **Cross reference links after verses** – the ⇅ character in square brackets, followed by the number of pointed cross references – they lead to vivid cross references which are typically shown in printed Bibles in between the two columns of the text. Cross references shown in the Bible text by defailt come from the RST-x cross references module.
- **Verse numbers** – they lead to the "Cross references" window, which adds dozens of more subtle cross references to the vivid cross references.

Bible text words are **implicit links**, activation of which looks up the tapped word in dictionaries and lexicons. MyBible automatically downloads a Strong's lexicon module, so a double-tap on a word in KJV+ causes a dictionary window to open and to shown you a lexicon article on a Hebrew or Koine word that was translated by the word you have double-tapped in the translation. This only works in literal translations having embedded Strong's numbers, i.e. for Bible modules, abbreviations of which end with "+".


KJV+
Gen 1:1
Chapter 1
The Creation of the World
1 In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth. [1:3]
Double-tap
2 And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters. [1:1]
3 And God said, Let there be light: and there was light. [1:1]
4 And God saw the light, that it was good: and God divided the light from the darkness.
5 And God called the light Day, and the darkness he called Night. And the evening and the morning were the first day.
6 And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters. [1:1]
7 And God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament: and it was so.
8 And God called the firmament Heaven. And the evening and the morning were the second day. [1:1]
9 And God said, Let the waters under the heaven be gathered together unto one place, and let the dry land appear: and it was so. [1:1]
10 And God called the dry land Earth; and the



Selection of a Bible position

Selection of a Bible position allows to jump to a desired place. Users have different preferenced on what is an efficent way of selecting a Bible position; for that, MyBible has several variants of the Bible position selection user interface.

The first way of selection, the default one, is presenting all books, all book chapters, all chapter verses on the screen, with no scrolling required even for the biggest numbers of books and chapters.


Select Book - KJV+
Gen Exo Lev Num Deu Josh
Judg Ruth 1Sam 2Sam 1Kin 2Kin
1Chr 2Chr Ezr Neh Esth Job
Ps Prov Eccl Song Isa Jer
Lam Ezek Dan Hos Joel Am
Oba Jona Mic Nah Hab Zeph
Hag Zech Mal Mat Mar Luk
John Acts Rom 1Cor 2Cor Gal
Eph Phil Col 1Ths 2Ths 1Tim
2Tim Tit Phlm Heb Jam 1Pet
2Pet 1Jn 2Jn 3Jn Jud Rev


Psalms - KJV+
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18
19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27
28 29 30 31 32 33 34 35 36
37 38 39 40 41 42 43 44 45
46 47 48 49 50 51 52 53 54
55 56 57 58 59 60 61 62 63
64 65 66 67 68 69 70 71 72
73 74 75 76 77 78 79 80 81
82 83 84 85 86 87 88 89 90
91 92 93 94 95 96 97 98 99
100 101 102 103 104 105 106 107 108
109 110 111 112 113 114 115 116 117
118 119 120 121 122 123 124 125 126
127 128 129 130 131 132 133 134 135
136 137 138 139 140 141 142 143 144
145 146 147 148 149 150



The book and chapter selection screens support the long tap on buttons – proceeding to the begining of a book or a chapter.

The button in the book selection window header that is shown in the screenshot below switches to **the second way of selection**, which combines the book selection area and the numeric position entry area.

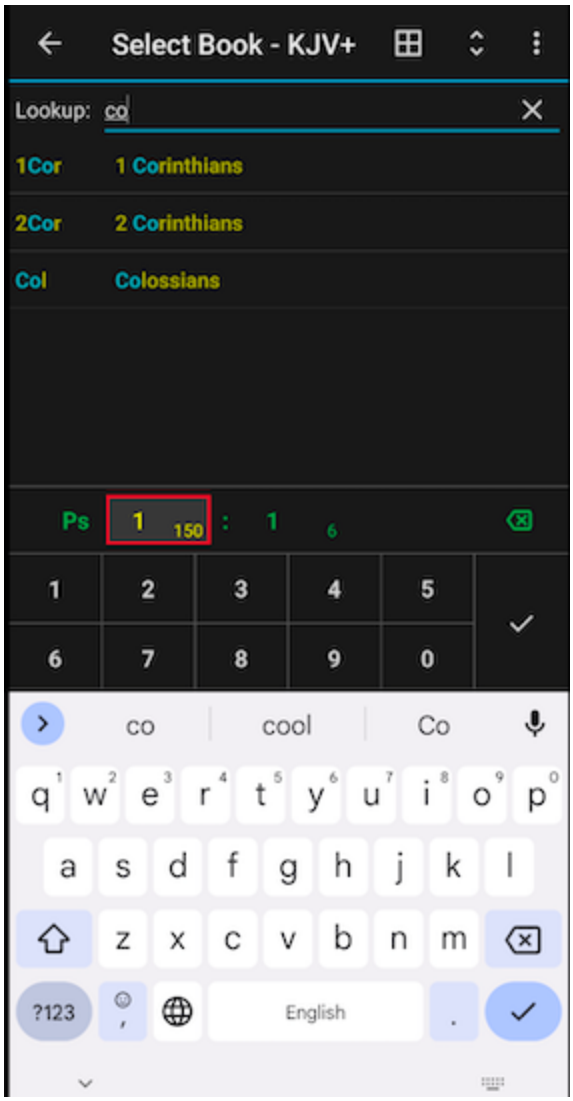

Select Book - KJV+
Gen Exo Lev Num Deu Josh
Judg Ruth 1Sam 2Sam 1Kin 2Kin
1Chr 2Chr Ezr Neh Esth Job
Ps Prov Eccl Song Isa Jer
Lam Ezek Dan Hos Joel Am
Oba Jona Mic Nah Hab Zeph
Hag Zech Mal Mat Mar Luk
John Acts Rom 1Cor 2Cor Gal
Eph Phil Col 1Ths 2Ths 1Tim
2Tim Tit Phlm Heb Jam 1Pet
2Pet 1Jn 2Jn 3Jn Jud Rev



Note that the chapter number and verse number entry fields indicate in their lower right corner the number of chapters in the currently selected book and the number of verses in the currently indicated chapter.

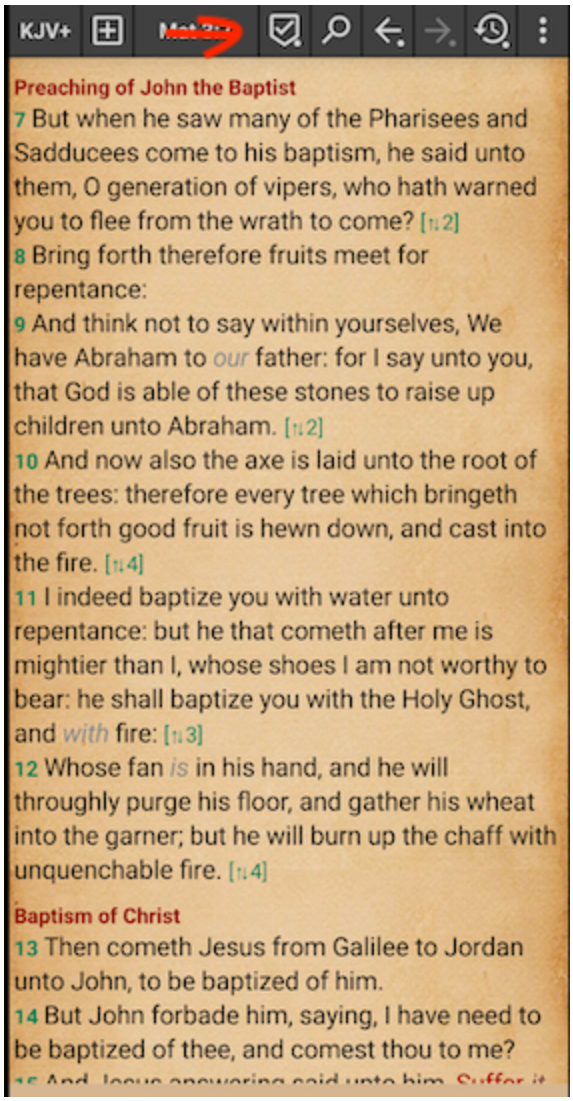
You can have the book selection as a list rather than a grid of buttons – in both the first and the second way of selection.

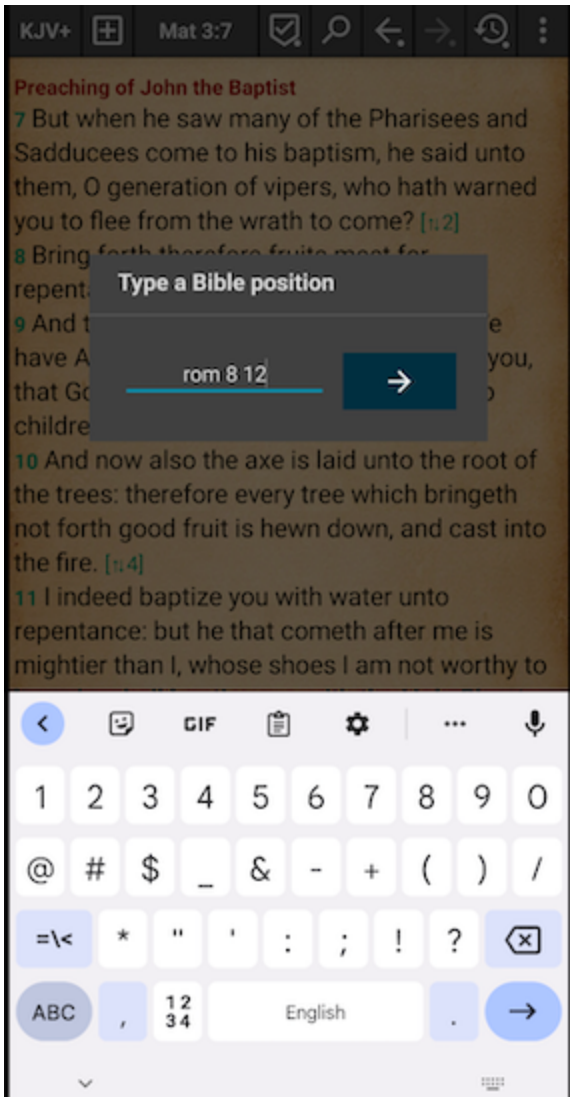

Select Book - KJV+
Gen Exo Lev Num Deu Josh
Judg Ruth 1Sam 2Sam 1Kin 2Kin
1Chr 2Chr Ezr Neh Esth Job
Ps Prov Eccl Song Isa Jer
Lam Ezek Dan Hos Joel Am
Oba Jona Mic Nah Hab Zeph
Hag Zech Mal Mat Mar Luk
John Acts Rom 1Cor 2Cor Gal
Eph Phil Col 1Ths 2Ths 1Tim
2Tim Tit Phlm Heb Jam 1Pet
2Pet 1Jn 2Jn 3Jn Jud Rev
Ps 1 150 : 1 6
1 2 3 4 5
6 7 8 9 0



Note the lookup field there. You could consider the list of books as **the third way of selection**.

Finally, some users prefer to just type in a desired Bible position. Do a horizontal fling on a position selection button to bring up **the fourth way of selection** – the position entry dialog.


KJV+
Preaching of John the Baptist
7 But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees come to his baptism, he said unto them, O generation of vipers, who hath warned you to flee from the wrath to come? [↑↓2]
8 Bring forth therefore fruits meet for repentance:
9 And think not to say within yourselves, We have Abraham to our father: for I say unto you, that God is able of these stones to raise up children unto Abraham. [↑↓2]
10 And now also the axe is laid unto the root of the trees: therefore every tree which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire. [↑↓4]
11 I indeed baptize you with water unto repentance: but he that cometh after me is mightier than I, whose shoes I am not worthy to bear: he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost, and with fire: [↑↓3]
12 Whose fan is in his hand, and he will throughly purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the garner; but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire. [↑↓4]
Baptism of Christ
13 Then cometh Jesus from Galilee to Jordan unto John, to be baptized of him.
14 But John forbade him, saying, I have need to be baptized of thee, and comest thou to me?



Just type there a book abbreviation, optionally followed by a space and a chapter number, optionally followed by a verse number. The “Go” (arrow right) button in the dialog is enabled when MyBible recognises the entered position – a known abbreviation, an existing chapter number, an existing verse number in a specified chapter.

Buttons

So you now know how to scroll, how to navigate and have some idea about the links in the Bible text. Now, what are the buttons at the top?

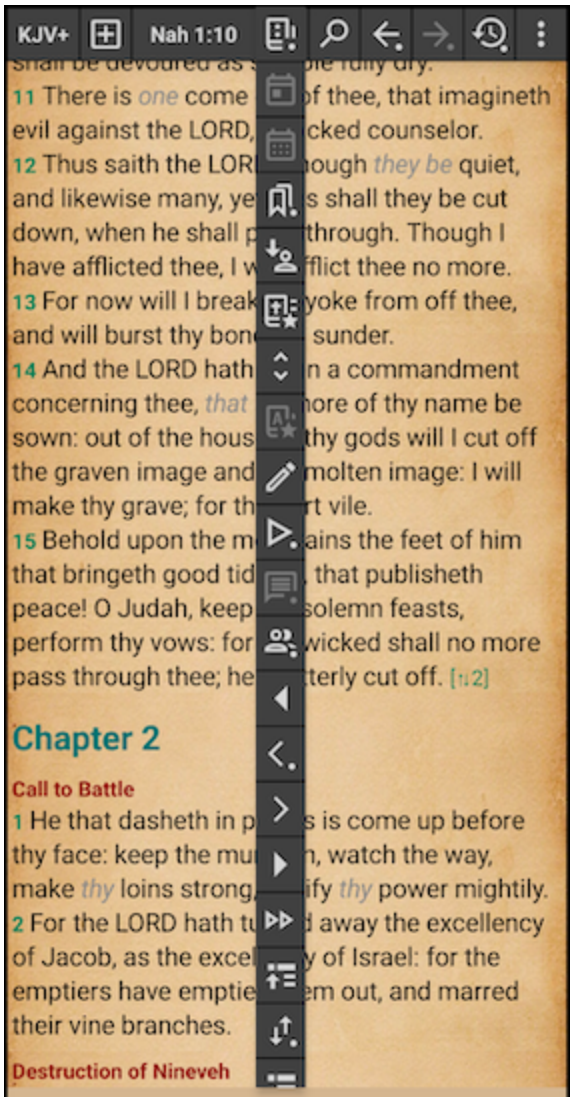
There are a several fixed ones and there is a whole lot of configurable ones.

The fixed buttons are, left to right:

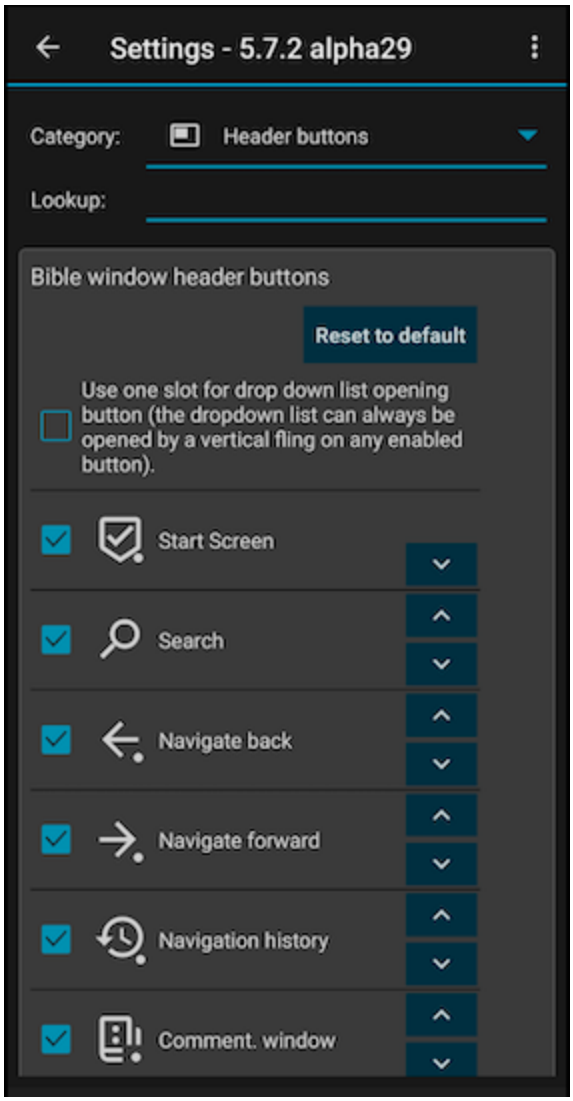
- Bible module button
- Window control button

- Bible position indicator & button – you are already familiar with this one from the above info
- Menu button at the very right, which calls the main menu by a simple tap and sub-menus by a long tap

Configurable buttons are between the Bible position button and the menu button. Those buttons, which can easily be perceived at first as unnecessary “bells and whistles”, provide access to the main spectrum of the MyBible functionality. Here is how it looks when you do a vertical fling on one of them to acces the rest of them that did not fit the window height.

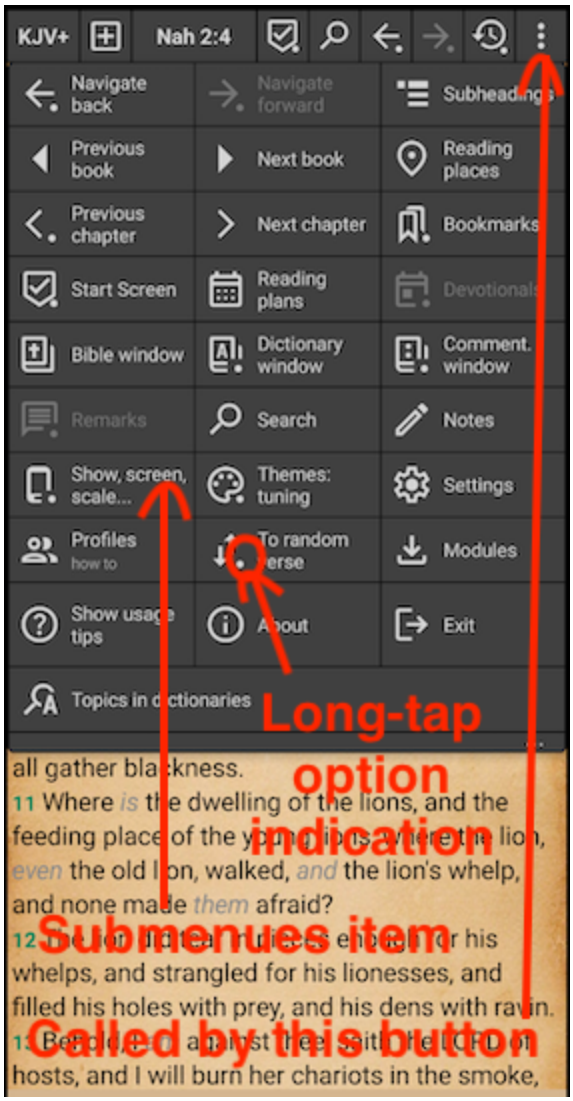


If you study the purpose of the configurable buttons and arrange them to your everyday usage convenience, you will see that there is almost no need the main menu. In order to study the buttons, go to the main menu, the “Settings” item, and select the “Header buttons” item. The list allows you to see button descriptions, to hide the uneeded ones and to re-arrange them, so that the most important ones for you are at the top of the list (and thus are shown in the header) and the the rest are arranged for your convenience.

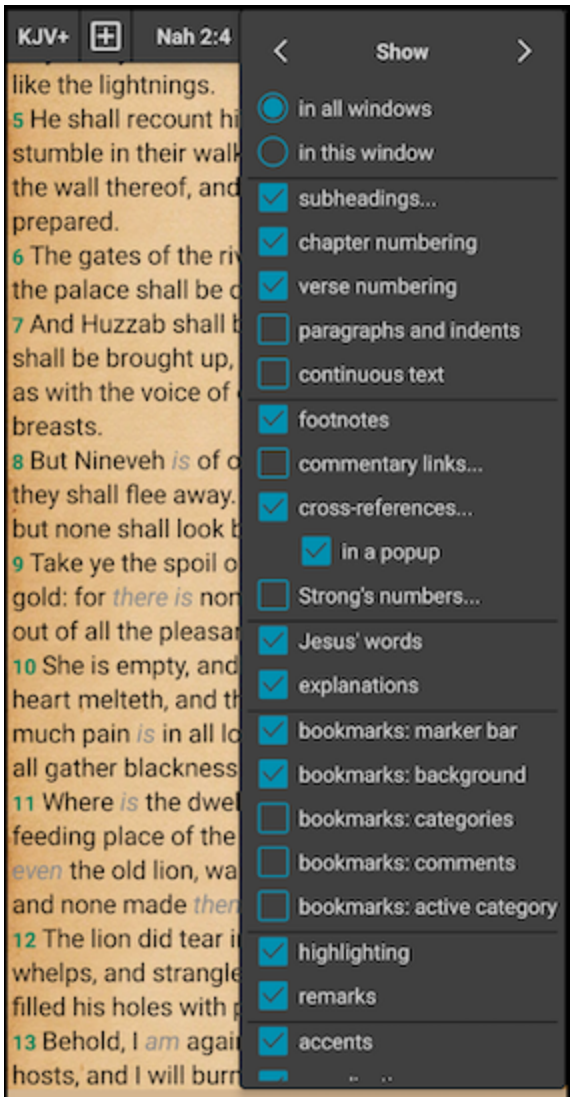


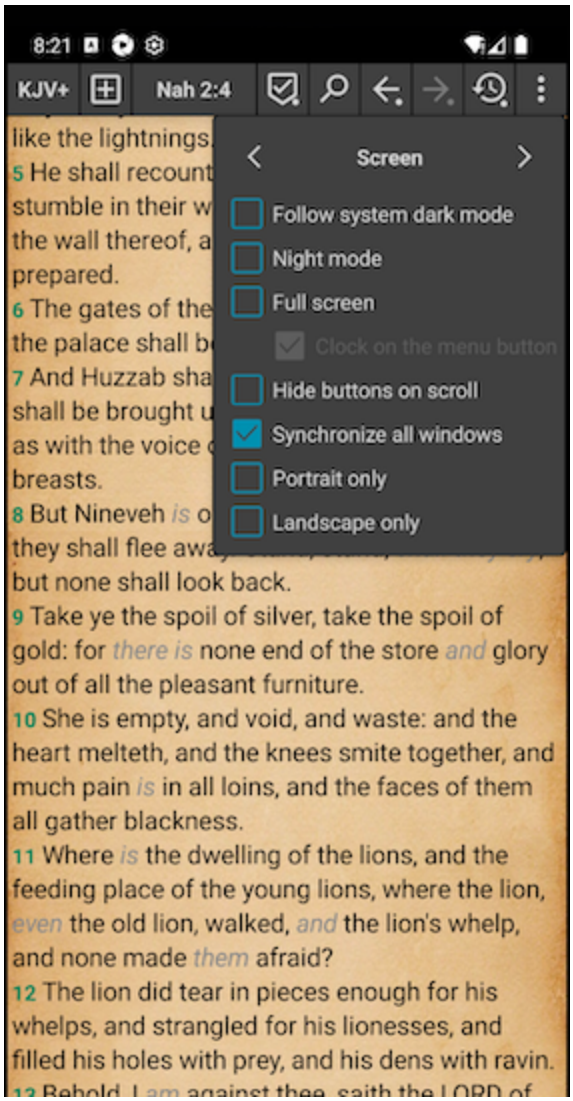
Main menu and sub-menus

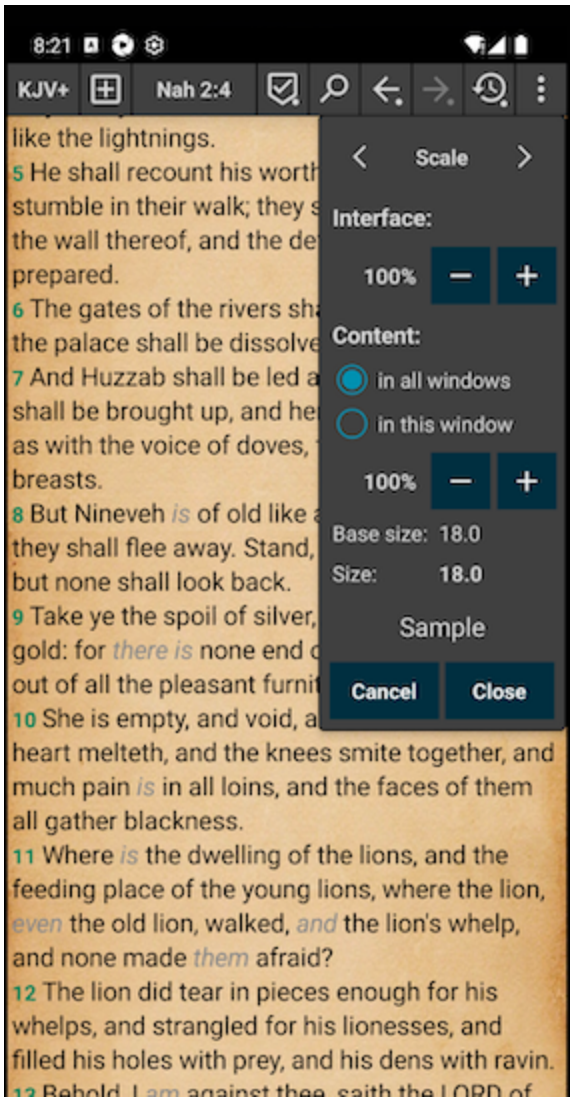
Here is how the MyBible main menu looks like by default:

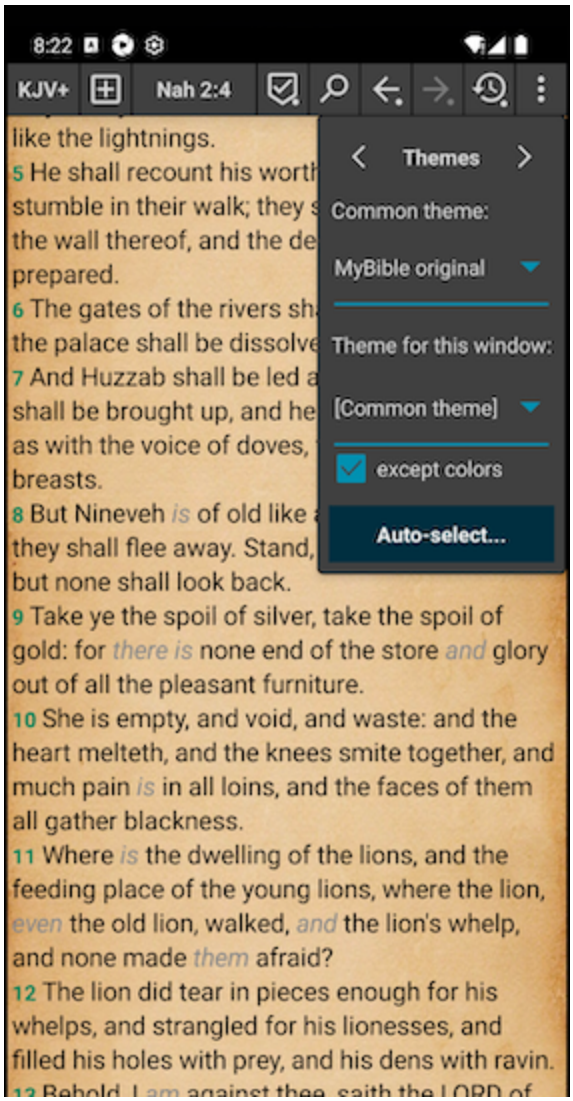


And here are the sub-menus:


KJV+
Nah 2:4
like the lightnings.
5 He shall recount hi
stumble in their walk
the wall thereof, and
prepared.
6 The gates of the ri
the palace shall be c
7 And Huzzab shall b
shall be brought up,
as with the voice of
breasts.
8 But Nineveh is of o
they shall flee away.
but none shall look b
9 Take ye the spoil o
gold: for there is non
out of all the pleasar
10 She is empty, and
heart melteth, and th
much pain is in all lo
all gather blackness
11 Where is the dwel
feeding place of the
even the old lion, wa
and none made ther
12 The lion did tear i
whelps, and strangle
filled his holes with p
13 Behold, I am agai
hosts, and I will burn
Show
in all windows
in this window
subheadings...
chapter numbering
verse numbering
paragraphs and indents
continuous text
footnotes
commentary links...
cross-references...
in a popup
Strong's numbers...
Jesus' words
explanations
bookmarks: marker bar
bookmarks: background
bookmarks: categories
bookmarks: comments
bookmarks: active category
highlighting
remarks
accents


8:21
KJV+
Nah 2:4
like the lightnings.
5 He shall recount
stumble in their w
the wall thereof, a
prepared.
6 The gates of the
the palace shall b
7 And Huzzab sha
shall be brought u
as with the voice
breasts.
8 But Nineveh is o
they shall flee awa
but none shall look back.
9 Take ye the spoil of silver, take the spoil of gold: for there is none end of the store and glory out of all the pleasant furniture.
10 She is empty, and void, and waste: and the heart melteth, and the knees smite together, and much pain is in all loins, and the faces of them all gather blackness.
11 Where is the dwelling of the lions, and the feeding place of the young lions, where the lion, even the old lion, walked, and the lion's whelp, and none made them afraid?
12 The lion did tear in pieces enough for his whelps, and strangled for his lionesses, and filled his holes with prey, and his dens with ravin.
Screen
Follow system dark mode
Night mode
Full screen
Clock on the menu button
Hide buttons on scroll
Synchronize all windows
Portrait only
Landscape only

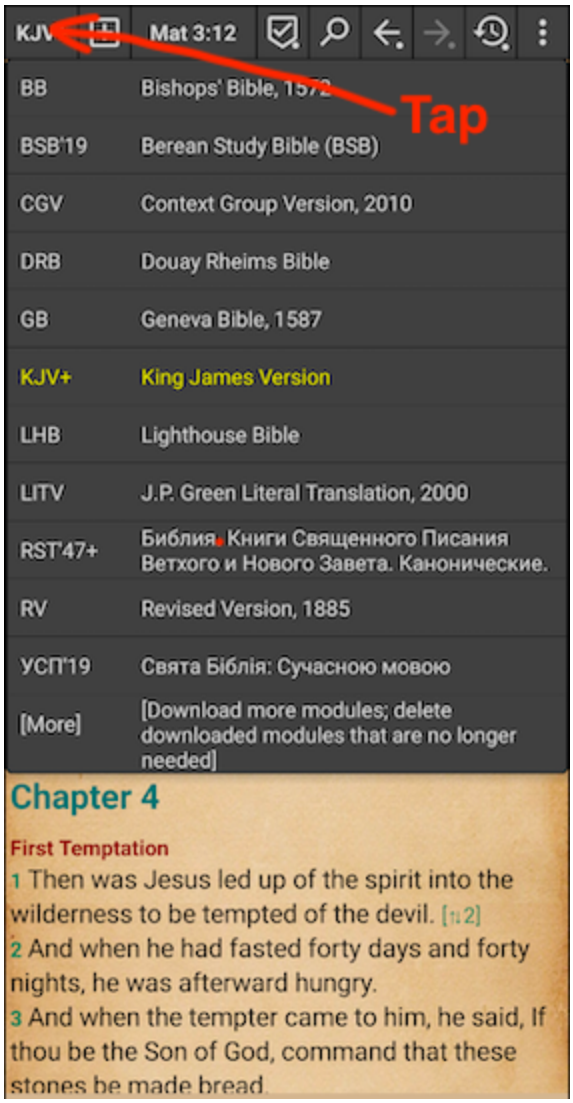

8:21
KJV+
Nah 2:4
like the lightnings.
5 He shall recount his worth
stumble in their walk; they s
the wall thereof, and the de
prepared.
6 The gates of the rivers sha
the palace shall be dissolve
7 And Huzzab shall be led a
shall be brought up, and he
as with the voice of doves,
breasts.
8 But Nineveh is of old like
they shall flee away. Stand,
but none shall look back.
9 Take ye the spoil of silver,
gold: for there is none end o
out of all the pleasant furnit
10 She is empty, and void, a
heart melteth, and the knees smite together, and
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and none made them afraid?
12 The lion did tear in pieces enough for his
whelps, and strangled for his lionesses, and
filled his holes with prey, and his dens with ravin.
Scale
Interface:
100%
Content:
in all windows
in this window
100%
Base size: 18.0
Size: 18.0
Sample
Cancel
Close



Selection of a Bible module

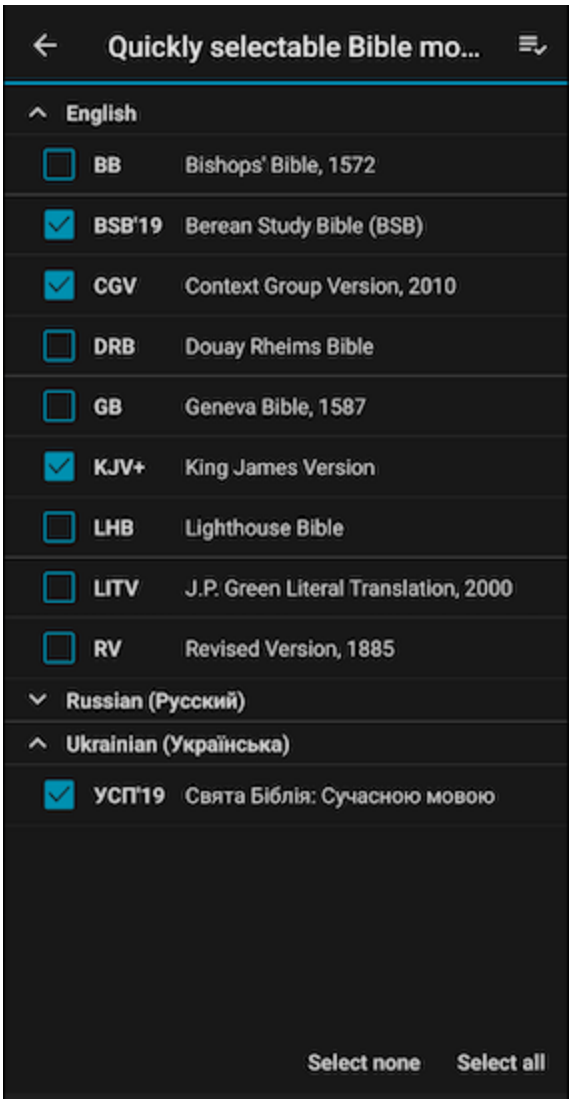
In addition to defaut modules that MyBible automatically downloads during the first start, you can download additional Bible modules (they are called “modules”, not “translations”, to be fair to texts of the original Bible manuscripts in Hebrew and Koine).

The leftmost button, the Bible module button, allows to select one of downloaded modules to be shown in the Bible window.

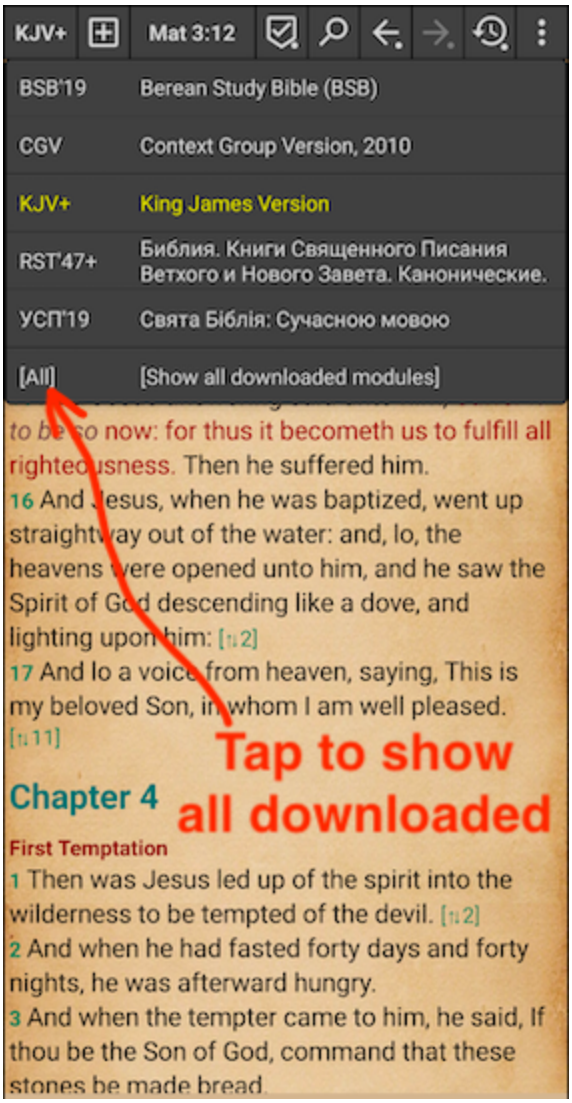


If you have more than a few Bible modules downloaded, perhaps some for a frequent use and others just for an occasional checking, having a long list of Bible modules to choose from takes some extra moments to find and tap a needed one. MyBible allows to limit the immediately shown modules using a **long-tap on the Bible module button**.

MyBible allows to specify **quickly selectable** Bible modules – as a list of all the downloaded Bible modules, grouped by language, with check marks on them:



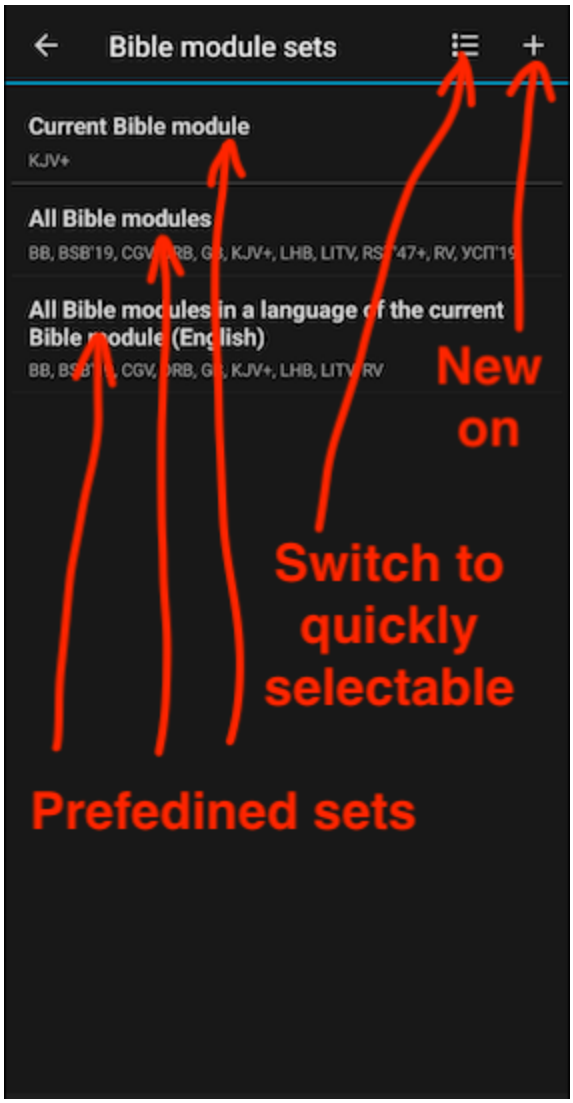
As the result, the list of modules will be down to your few frequently used Bible modules, with the rest of the modules just one tap away on the “[All]” item:



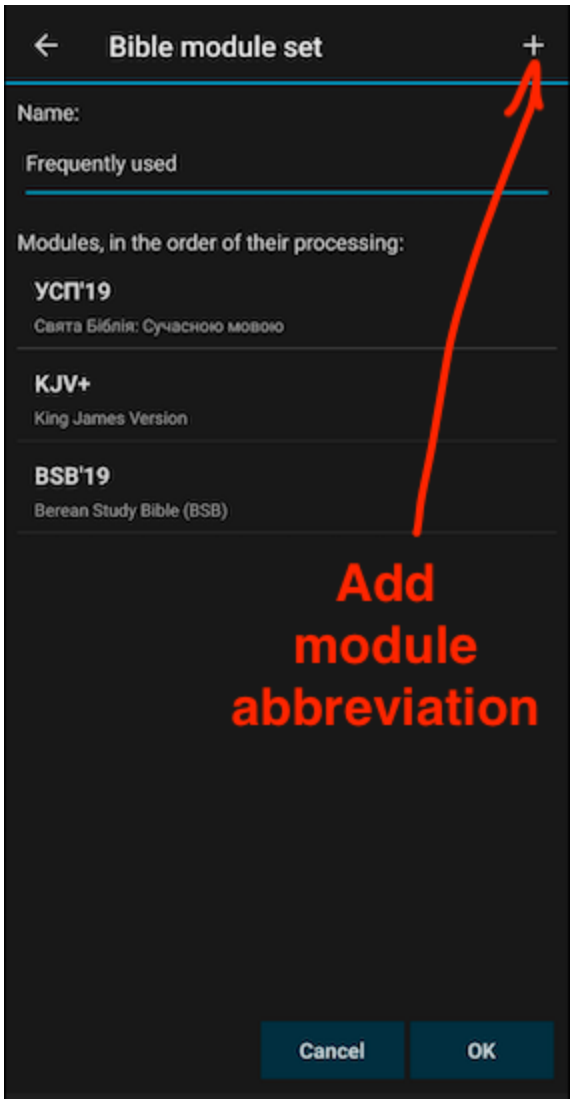
All the above shows modules in the alphabetical order of their abbreviations.

MyBible also supports named Bible module sets, in which you can select and order Bible modules to your liking. Here is how to switch from quickly selectable modules to module sets:


Quickly selectable Bible mo...
English
Russian (Русский)
Ukrainian (Українська)
Switching from quickly selectable to Bible module sets
Select none
Select all

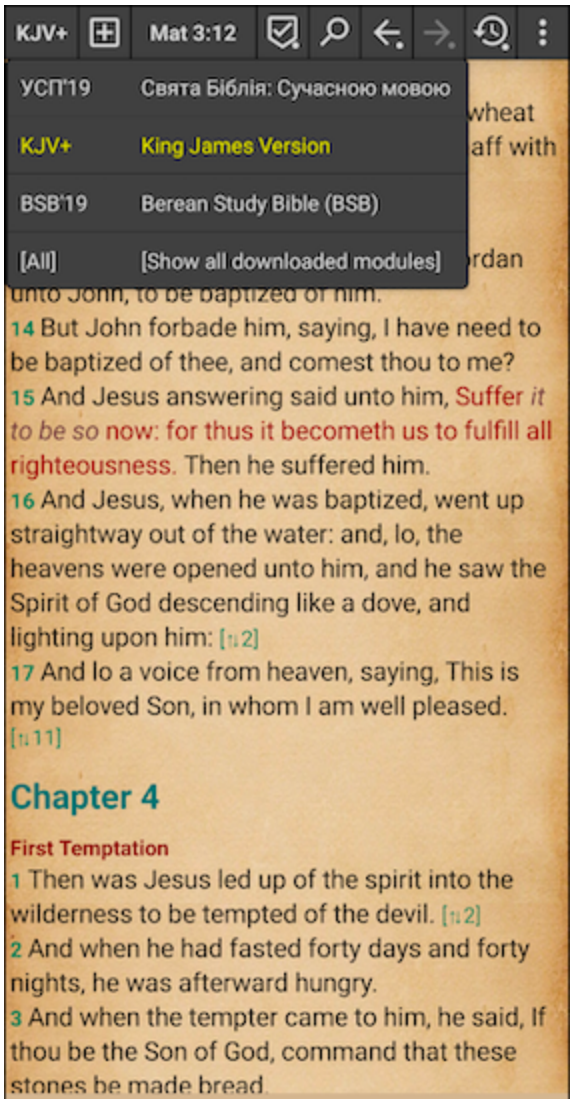


Here is how adding of a new Bible module set looks like:



Select an abbreviation in the list to move it up or down in the list or to delete it.

After adding a Bible module set, tap it in the list of module sets to activate it. As the result, the list of Bible modules to select from is per a selected module set, and notice the sorting that you can adjust as desired in this case. And you still have the “[All]” item in the list, which shows all the downloaded Bible modules in the alphabetical order of their abbreviations.



Lacking something you are used to?

As it is explained at the top of this article, there are no, and not going to be, text pages to flip.

If you lack something else, please look through the main functionality usage tips (in fact, all the usage tips are recomended to study in order to wrap your head aroung all the possibilities you have in MyBible).

Too much of everyting?

Read here then.